Theme 5 title 4 child edition

26-11-07 23:10pm Sat

THE OLD TESTAMENT DETECTIVE
30 Days of Finding Clues About Jesus in the Heroes
[Author Name]
Illustrated by [Illustrator Name]

Copyright © [Year] [Author Name]. All rights reserved. This printable is for personal family use only. Not for resale. No part of this book may be reproduced in any form without permission from the author.

A Note for Parents

Have you ever played a game of detective? You put on a hat. You grab a magnifying glass. You look for clues. You look for fingerprints. You look for footprints. You look for anything that will help you solve the mystery. The Old Testament is like a detective game. It is full of clues. It is full of fingerprints. It is full of footprints. And every clue points to one person. Every fingerprint belongs to one person. Every footprint belongs to one person. That person is Jesus.

This book is a 30 day adventure for you and your kids. We are going to be detectives. We are going to look for clues. We are going to follow the footprints. We are going to solve the mystery. You do not need to be a Bible expert to lead this. You just need to be willing to explore with your kids. Get ready to put on your detective hats. Get ready to grab your magnifying glasses. Get ready to find Jesus.

How to Use This Book

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the secret clue. Read the big reveal. Do the family activity together. Say the prayer out loud. Let your child color the picture. The goal is not perfection. The goal is connection. Have fun with it. Get messy. Ask questions. Laugh together. This is an adventure. Let us begin.

Day 01: The Clue of the Firstborn

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Consecrate to me every firstborn male. The first offspring of every womb among the Israelites belongs to me, whether human or animal." - Exodus 13:2

The firstborn was special. The firstborn was set apart. The firstborn belonged to God. The firstborn was a clue. The firstborn was a fingerprint. The firstborn was a footprint. And the firstborn points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For those God foreknew he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son, that he might be the firstborn among many brothers and sisters." - Romans 8:29

Jesus is the firstborn. He is the firstborn of all creation. He is the firstborn from the dead. He is the firstborn among many brothers and sisters. The firstborn in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Make a list of the firstborns in your family. Talk about how the firstborn was special in the Old Testament. Talk about how Jesus is the firstborn. He is the special one. He is the one who saves us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the firstborn. Thank you for making me part of the family. Thank you for including me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A family with a big heart in the middle.

Day 02: The Clue of the Lamb

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Your lamb shall be without blemish, a male a year old. You may take it from the sheep or from the goats." - Exodus 12:5

The lamb was a clue. The lamb had to be perfect. It had to be without blemish. It had to be without spot. It had to be sacrificed. The lamb was a fingerprint. The lamb was a footprint. And the lamb points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, 'Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!'" - John 1:29

Jesus is the Lamb. He is the Lamb of God. He is perfect. He is without blemish. He is without spot. He was sacrificed. The lamb in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a lamb. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how the lamb had to be perfect. Talk about how Jesus is the perfect Lamb.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the perfect Lamb. Thank you for taking away my sin. Thank you for loving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A fluffy white lamb with a big smile.

Day 03: The Clue of the Blood

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The blood will be a sign for you on the houses where you are, and when I see the blood, I will pass over you." - Exodus 12:13

The blood was a clue. The blood was a sign. It was a protection. It was a covering. The blood was a fingerprint. The blood was a footprint. And the blood points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"In him we have redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of sins, in accordance with the riches of God's grace." - Ephesians 1:7

Jesus is the blood. He is the one who shed His blood. He is the one who provides redemption. He is the one who provides forgiveness. The blood in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Cut out a paper door. Color it red. Tape it to your child's bedroom door. Talk about how the blood saved the people. Talk about how the blood of Jesus saves us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for your blood. Thank you for saving me. Thank you for protecting me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A door painted with a red stripe.

Day 04: The Clue of the Bread

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then the LORD said to Moses, 'I will rain down bread from heaven for you. The people are to go out each day and gather enough for that day.'" - Exodus 16:4

The bread was a clue. The bread was manna. It was from heaven. It was a provision. The bread was a fingerprint. The bread was a footprint. And the bread points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I am the bread of life. Whoever comes to me will never go hungry, and whoever believes in me will never be thirsty." - John 6:35

Jesus is the bread. He is the bread of life. He is the provision. He is the one who satisfies. The bread in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Bake a simple flatbread together. Or buy some pita bread. Talk about how the bread is flat because it has no yeast. Talk about how Jesus is the bread of life.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the bread of life. Thank you for feeding me. Thank you for satisfying me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A round loaf of flatbread with a big smile.

Day 05: The Clue of the Water

The Secret Clue (OT)
"I will stand there before you by the rock at Horeb. Strike the rock, and water will come out of it for the people to drink." - Exodus 17:6

The water was a clue. The water came from the rock. It was a miracle. It was a provision. The water was a fingerprint. The water was a footprint. And the water points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Whoever believes in me, as Scripture has said, rivers of living water will flow from within them." - John 7:38

Jesus is the water. He is the living water. He is the source of life. He is the one who quenches thirst. The water in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Drink a glass of water. As you drink it, thank Jesus for being the living water. Thank Him for refreshing your soul.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the living water. Thank you for quenching my thirst. Thank you for refreshing my soul. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful river flowing through a garden with a big smile.

Day 06: The Clue of the Rock

The Secret Clue (OT)
"He is the Rock, his works are perfect, and all his ways are just. A faithful God who does no wrong, upright and just is he." - Deuteronomy 32:4

The rock was a clue. The rock was a symbol. It was a symbol of strength. It was a symbol of stability. The rock was a fingerprint. The rock was a footprint. And the rock points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"They all drank from the spiritual rock that accompanied them, and that rock was Christ." - 1 Corinthians 10:4

Jesus is the rock. He is the spiritual rock. He is the foundation. He is the cornerstone. The rock in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Find a rock. Hold it in your hand. Feel its strength. Thank Jesus for being your rock. Thank Him for being your foundation.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the rock. Thank you for being the foundation. Thank you for being the cornerstone. Help me to build my life on you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big rock with a cross and a big smile on it.

Day 07: The Clue of the Serpent

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So Moses made a bronze snake and put it up on a pole. Then when anyone was bitten by a snake and looked at the bronze snake, they lived." - Numbers 21:9

The serpent was a clue. The serpent was lifted up. It was a symbol. The serpent was a fingerprint. The serpent was a footprint. And the serpent points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Just as Moses lifted up the snake in the wilderness, so the Son of Man must be lifted up, that everyone who believes may have eternal life in him." - John 3:14-15

Jesus is the serpent. He was lifted up. He was lifted up on a cross. He was lifted up for us. The serpent in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a snake on a pole. Write the name "Jesus" next to it. Talk about how the people looked at the snake and lived. Talk about how we look at Jesus and live.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being lifted up for me. Thank you for the promise that whoever looks at you will live. I am looking at you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A wooden pole with a bronze snake and a big smile.

Day 08: The Clue of the Veil

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Hang the curtain from the clasps and place the ark of the covenant law behind the curtain. The curtain will separate the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place." - Exodus 26:33

The veil was a clue. The veil was a barrier. It was a separation. The veil was a fingerprint. The veil was a footprint. And the veil points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"At that moment the curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom." - Matthew 27:51

Jesus is the veil. He is the barrier. He is the torn curtain. He is the fulfillment of the veil. The veil in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a curtain. Then draw a line through it, tearing it in two. Write the word "Jesus" on the tear. Thank Him for opening the way to God.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for opening the way. Thank you for removing the barrier. Thank you for tearing the curtain. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A torn curtain with a big heart and a cross.

Day 09: The Clue of the High Priest

The Secret Clue (OT)

"The LORD said to Moses: 'Tell your brother Aaron that he is not to come whenever he chooses into the Most Holy Place behind the curtain in front of the atonement cover on the ark, or else he will die.'" - Leviticus 16:2

The high priest was a clue. The high priest was the mediator. He was the go-between. The high priest was a fingerprint. The high priest was a footprint. And the high priest points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Therefore, since we have a great high priest who has ascended into heaven, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold firmly to the faith we profess." - Hebrews 4:14

Jesus is the high priest. He is the mediator. He is the go-between. He is the fulfillment of the high priest. The high priest in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a priest. Write the name "Jesus" on his chest. Talk about how the high priest talked to God for the people. Talk about how Jesus talks to God for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my high priest. Thank you for representing me. Thank you for interceding for me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A high priest with a big heart on his chest.

Day 10: The Clue of the Sacrifice

The Secret Clue (OT)
"For the life of a creature is in the blood, and I have given it to you to make atonement for yourselves on the altar; it is the blood that makes atonement for one's life." - Leviticus 17:11

The sacrifice was a clue. The sacrifice was an offering. It was an atonement. The sacrifice was a fingerprint. The sacrifice was a footprint. And the sacrifice points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For Christ also suffered once for sins, the righteous for the unrighteous, to bring you to God." - 1 Peter 3:18

Jesus is the sacrifice. He is the offering. He is the atonement. He is the fulfillment of the sacrifice. The sacrifice in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity

Draw a picture of an altar. Put a toy animal on it. Talk about how the sacrifice was for sins. Talk about how Jesus was the sacrifice for our sins.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the sacrifice. Thank you for being the offering. Thank you for being the atonement. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
An altar with a big heart on it.

Day 11: The Clue of the Scapegoat

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The goat will carry on itself all their sins to a remote place; and the man shall release it in the wilderness." - Leviticus 16:22

The scapegoat was a clue. The scapegoat carried the sins. It carried them away. The scapegoat was a fingerprint. The scapegoat was a footprint. And the scapegoat points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"We all, like sheep, have gone astray, each of us has turned to our own way; and the LORD has laid on him the iniquity of us all." - Isaiah 53:6

Jesus is the scapegoat. He carried our sins. He carried them away. He is the fulfillment of the scapegoat. The scapegoat in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Write a mistake on a piece of paper. Tie it to a balloon. Let the balloon go. Watch it float away. Thank Jesus for carrying your sins away.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for carrying my sins away. Thank you for removing them. Thank you for taking them to the cross. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A goat with a big heart on it.

Day 12: The Clue of the Red Heifer

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Tell the Israelites to bring you a red heifer without defect or blemish and that has never been under a yoke." - Numbers 19:2

The red heifer was a clue. The red heifer was a sacrifice. It was a cleansing. The red heifer was a fingerprint. The red heifer was a footprint. And the red heifer points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The high priest carries the blood of animals into the Most Holy Place as a sin offering, but the bodies are burned outside the camp. And so Jesus also suffered outside the city gate to make the people holy through his own blood." - Hebrews 13:11-12

Jesus is the red heifer. He suffered outside the city gate. He was burned. He was the cleansing. He is the fulfillment of the red heifer. The red heifer in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Wash your hands. As you wash them, thank Jesus for cleansing you. Thank Him for making you holy.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for cleansing me. Thank you for purifying me. Thank you for making me holy. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A red cow with a big smile.

Day 13: The Clue of the Day of Atonement

The Secret Clue (OT)
"This is to be a lasting ordinance for you: On the tenth day of the seventh month you must deny yourselves and not do any work—whether native-born or a foreigner residing among you—because on this day atonement will be made for you, to cleanse you." - Leviticus 16:29-30

The Day of Atonement was a clue. It was a day of cleansing. It was a day of forgiveness. The Day of Atonement was a fingerprint. The Day of Atonement was a footprint. And the Day of Atonement points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"He did not enter by means of the blood of goats and calves; but he entered the Most Holy Place once for all by his own blood, thus obtaining eternal redemption." - Hebrews 9:12

Jesus is the Day of Atonement. He is the high priest. He is the sacrifice. He entered the Most Holy Place once for all. He obtained eternal redemption. The Day of Atonement in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity

Write down this truth: "Jesus made atonement for me." Say it out loud. Thank Him for His atonement.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my Day of Atonement. Thank you for making atonement for me. Thank you for cleansing me. Thank you for forgiving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a cross and a big smile inside it.

Day 14: The Clue of the Tabernacle

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then the cloud covered the tent of meeting, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle." - Exodus 40:34

The tabernacle was a clue. The tabernacle was a dwelling. It was a tent. The tabernacle was a fingerprint. The tabernacle was a footprint. And the tabernacle points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son, who came from the Father, full of grace and truth." - John 1:14

Jesus is the tabernacle. He is the dwelling. He is the tent. He is the fulfillment of the tabernacle. The tabernacle in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Build a blanket fort. Crawl inside. Sit in the quiet. Thank Jesus for dwelling with you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the tabernacle. Thank you for dwelling among us. Thank you for being with me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful tent with a big cloud of glory above it.

Day 15: The Clue of the Temple

The Secret Clue (OT)
"I have indeed built a magnificent temple for you, a place for you to dwell forever." - 1 Kings 8:13

The temple was a clue. The temple was a building. It was a house. The temple was a fingerprint. The temple was a footprint. And the temple points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Jesus answered them, 'Destroy this temple, and I will raise it again in three days.' But the temple he had spoken of was his body." - John 2:19-21

Jesus is the temple. He is the building. He is the house. He is the fulfillment of the temple. The temple in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a beautiful building. Write the name "Jesus" on the door. Talk about how Jesus is the temple. He is the place where we meet God.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the temple. Thank you for being the meeting place. Thank you for being the worship place. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful building with a big heart on the door.

Day 16: The Clue of the Priest

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Have Aaron your brother brought to you from among the Israelites, along with his sons Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar, so they may serve me as priests." - Exodus 28:1

The priest was a clue. The priest was a mediator. He was an intercessor. The priest was a fingerprint. The priest was a footprint. And the priest points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For there is one God and one mediator between God and mankind, the man Christ Jesus." - 1 Timothy 2:5

Jesus is the priest. He is the mediator. He is the intercessor. He is the fulfillment of the priest. The priest in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a priest. Write the name "Jesus" on his chest. Talk about how the priest talked to God for the people. Talk about how Jesus talks to God for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my priest. Thank you for being my mediator. Thank you for being my intercessor. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A priest with a big heart on his chest.

Day 17: The Clue of the King

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The LORD your God will raise up for you a king from among your fellow Israelites. You must listen to him." - Deuteronomy 17:15

The king was a clue. The king was a ruler. He was a leader. The king was a fingerprint. The king was a footprint. And the king points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For to us a child is born, to us a son is given, and the government will be on his shoulders. And he will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace." - Isaiah 9:6

Jesus is the king. He is the ruler. He is the leader. He is the fulfillment of the king. The king in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Make a paper crown. Put it on your child's head. Say, "You are a child of the King." Thank Jesus for being your King.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my king. Thank you for ruling me. Thank you for leading me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A golden crown with a big heart on it.

Day 18: The Clue of the Prophet

The Secret Clue (OT)
"I will raise up for them a prophet like you from among their fellow Israelites, and I will put my words in his mouth." - Deuteronomy 18:18

The prophet was a clue. The prophet was a messenger. He was a spokesman. The prophet was a fingerprint. The prophet was a footprint. And the prophet points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For Moses said, 'The Lord your God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among your own people; you must listen to everything he tells you.'" - Acts 3:22

Jesus is the prophet. He is the messenger. He is the spokesman. He is the fulfillment of the prophet. The prophet in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Read a verse from the Bible. Ask Jesus to speak to you through it. Thank Him for being the prophet.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my prophet. Thank you for speaking for God. Thank you for revealing God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A person speaking with a big heart and a big smile.

Day 19: The Clue of the Shepherd

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The LORD is my shepherd, I lack nothing. He makes me lie down in green pastures, he leads me beside quiet waters." - Psalm 23:1-2

The shepherd was a clue. The shepherd was a guide. He was a protector. The shepherd was a fingerprint. The shepherd was a footprint. And the shepherd points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep." - John 10:11

Jesus is the shepherd. He is the guide. He is the protector. He is the fulfillment of the shepherd. The shepherd in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a shepherd with a sheep. Write the name "Jesus" above the shepherd. Thank Him for being your Good Shepherd.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my shepherd. Thank you for guiding me. Thank you for protecting me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A shepherd holding a fluffy lamb with a big smile.

Day 20: The Clue of the Rock

The Secret Clue (OT)
"He is the Rock, his works are perfect, and all his ways are just. A faithful God who does no wrong, upright and just is he." - Deuteronomy 32:4

The rock was a clue. The rock was a symbol. It was a symbol of strength. It was a symbol of stability. The rock was a fingerprint. The rock was a footprint. And the rock points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"They all drank from the spiritual rock that accompanied them, and that rock was Christ." - 1 Corinthians 10:4

Jesus is the rock. He is the spiritual rock. He is the foundation. He is the cornerstone. The rock in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Find a rock. Hold it in your hand. Feel its strength. Thank Jesus for being your rock.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the rock. Thank you for being the foundation. Thank you for being the cornerstone. Help me to build my life on you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big rock with a cross and a big smile on it.

Day 21: The Clue of the Manna

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then the LORD said to Moses, 'I will rain down bread from heaven for you. The people are to go out each day and gather enough for that day.'" - Exodus 16:4

The manna was a clue. The manna was bread from heaven. It was a provision. The manna was a fingerprint. The manna was a footprint. And the manna points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I am the bread of life. Whoever comes to me will never go hungry, and whoever believes in me will never be thirsty." - John 6:35

Jesus is the manna. He is the bread of life. He is the provision. He is the fulfillment of the manna. The manna in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Eat a piece of bread. As you eat it, thank Jesus for being the bread of life. Thank Him for satisfying your hunger.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the bread of life. Thank you for satisfying my hunger. Thank you for filling my soul. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big loaf of bread with a big smile on it.

Day 22: The Clue of the Water from the Rock

The Secret Clue (OT)
"I will stand there before you by the rock at Horeb. Strike the rock, and water will come out of it for the people to drink." - Exodus 17:6

The water came from the rock. It was a clue. It was a miracle. It was a provision. The water was a fingerprint. The water was a footprint. And the water points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Whoever believes in me, as Scripture has said, rivers of living water will flow from within them." - John 7:38

Jesus is the water. He is the living water. He is the source of life. He is the one who quenches thirst. The water in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Drink a glass of water. As you drink it, thank Jesus for being the living water. Thank Him for refreshing your soul.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the living water. Thank you for quenching my thirst. Thank you for refreshing my soul. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful river flowing through a garden with a big smile.

Day 23: The Clue of the Bronze Serpent

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So Moses made a bronze snake and put it up on a pole. Then when anyone was bitten by a snake and looked at the bronze snake, they lived." - Numbers 21:9

The bronze serpent was a clue. The bronze serpent was lifted up. It was a symbol. The bronze serpent was a fingerprint. The bronze serpent was a footprint. And the bronze serpent points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Just as Moses lifted up the snake in the wilderness, so the Son of Man must be lifted up, that everyone who believes may have eternal life in him." - John 3:14-15

Jesus is the bronze serpent. He was lifted up. He was lifted up on a cross. He was lifted up for us. The bronze serpent in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a cross. Write the word "Look" next to it. Every time you look at it, remember to look at Jesus.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being lifted up for me. Thank you for being raised on a cross. Thank you for the promise that whoever looks at you will live. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A wooden pole with a bronze snake and a big smile.

Day 24: The Clue of the Cities of Refuge

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Speak to the Israelites and say to them: 'Select some towns to be your cities of refuge, to which a person who has killed someone accidentally may flee.'" - Numbers 35:10-11

The cities of refuge were clues. They were safe places. They were sanctuaries. The cities of refuge were fingerprints. They were footprints. And they point to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus." - Romans 8:1

Jesus is the city of refuge. He is the safe place. He is the sanctuary. He is the fulfillment of the cities of refuge. The cities of refuge in the Old Testament are clues. They are fingerprints. They are footprints. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Find a quiet, safe place in your home. Sit there for a few minutes. Thank Jesus for being your city of refuge.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my city of refuge. Thank you for being my safe place. Thank you for being my sanctuary. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A strong tower with a big heart on it.

Day 25: The Clue of the Sabbath

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Remember the Sabbath day by keeping it holy. Six days you shall labor and do all your work, but the seventh day is a sabbath to the LORD your God." - Exodus 20:8-10

The Sabbath was a clue. The Sabbath was a day of rest. It was a day of peace. The Sabbath was a fingerprint. The Sabbath was a footprint. And the Sabbath points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." - Matthew 11:28

Jesus is the Sabbath. He is the rest. He is the peace. He is the fulfillment of the Sabbath. The Sabbath in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Take a nap. Read a book. Go for a walk. Do something restful. As you rest, thank Jesus for being your rest.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my rest. Thank you for being my peace. Thank you for giving me rest. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A person sleeping peacefully with a big smile and a little "Zzz."

Day 26: The Clue of the Jubilee

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Consecrate the fiftieth year and proclaim liberty throughout the land to all its inhabitants. It shall be a jubilee for you; each of you is to return to your family property and to your own clan." - Leviticus 25:10

The Jubilee was a clue. The Jubilee was a year of freedom. It was a year of release. The Jubilee was a fingerprint. The Jubilee was a footprint. And the Jubilee points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The Spirit of the Lord is on me, because he has anointed me to proclaim good news to the poor. He has sent me to proclaim freedom for the prisoners and recovery of sight for the blind, to set the oppressed free, to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor." - Luke 4:18-19

Jesus is the Jubilee. He is the freedom. He is the release. He is the fulfillment of the Jubilee. The Jubilee in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Ring a bell. Shout "Freedom!" Thank Jesus for setting you free. Thank Him for being your Jubilee.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my Jubilee. Thank you for proclaiming freedom to me. Thank you for releasing me. Thank you for restoring me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A bell with a big smile on it.

Day 27: The Clue of the Covenant

The Secret Clue (OT)
*"I establish my covenant with you: Never again will all life be destroyed by the waters of

……

Day 27: The Clue of the Covenant (Continued)

The Secret Clue (OT)
"I establish my covenant with you: Never again will all life be destroyed by the waters of a flood; never again will there be a flood to destroy the earth." - Genesis 9:11

The covenant was a clue. The covenant was an agreement. It was a promise. The covenant was a fingerprint. The covenant was a footprint. And the covenant points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"In the same way, after the supper he took the cup, saying, 'This cup is the new covenant in my blood, which is poured out for you.'" - Luke 22:20

Jesus is the covenant. He is the new covenant. He is the fulfillment of the covenant. The covenant in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a big scroll. Write the word "Promise" on it. Talk about how Jesus made a new promise with us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the new covenant. Thank you for the new promise. Help me to live in your promise. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big scroll with a heart and a cross on it.

Day 28: The Clue of the Rainbow

The Secret Clue (OT)
"I have set my rainbow in the clouds, and it will be the sign of the covenant between me and the earth." - Genesis 9:13

The rainbow was a clue. The rainbow was a sign. It was a promise. The rainbow was a fingerprint. The rainbow was a footprint. And the rainbow points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And I saw the dead, great and small, standing before the throne, and books were opened. Another book was opened, which is the book of life. The dead were judged according to what they had done as recorded in the books." - Revelation 20:12

Jesus is the one who opens the book of life. He is the one who judges. He is the one who saves. The rainbow in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a rainbow. Write the word "Promise" under it. Thank God for keeping His promises to you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the rainbow. Thank you for the sign. Thank you for the promise. Thank you for the reminder. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful rainbow stretching across the sky with a big smile.

Day 29: The Clue of the Tower

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then they said, 'Come, let us build ourselves a city, with a tower that reaches to the heavens, so that we may make a name for ourselves; otherwise we will be scattered over the face of the whole earth.'" - Genesis 11:4

The tower was a clue. The tower was a city. It was a name. The tower was a fingerprint. The tower was a footprint. And the tower points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)

"For this reason God highly exalted him and gave him the name that is above every name, so that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth." - Philippians 2:9-10

Jesus is the tower. He is the name. He is the fulfillment of the tower. The tower in the Old Testament is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Build a tower out of blocks. See how high you can make it. Then knock it down. Talk about how Jesus is the one who makes a name that lasts forever.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making a name that is above every name. Thank you for coming down to reach me. Help me to trust your name. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A tall tower with a big smile and a little heart at the top.

Day 30: The Clue of the Promise to Abraham

The Secret Clue (OT)
"I will make you into a great nation, and I will bless you; I will make your name great, and you will be a blessing. I will bless those who bless you, and whoever curses you I will curse; and all peoples on earth will be blessed through you." - Genesis 12:2-3

The promise to Abraham was a clue. It was a hope. It was a future. The promise was a fingerprint. The promise was a footprint. And the promise points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"This is the genealogy of Jesus the Messiah the son of David, the son of Abraham..." - Matthew 1:1

Jesus is the fulfillment of the promise. He is the descendant of Abraham. He is the one who blesses the whole world. The promise to Abraham is a clue. It is a fingerprint. It is a footprint. The reality is Jesus.

Family Activity
Think about your family. Write down one way you can be a blessing to them this week. Ask God to help you do it.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for the promise. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for making me part of your family. Help me to be a blessing to others. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big family with a big heart in the middle and a shining star above.

END MATTER

The "Old Testament Detective" Certificate

This certifies that [Child's Name] has completed The Old Testament Detective adventure. You followed 30 secret clues and discovered the greatest treasure: Jesus. You are officially an Old Testament Detective.

Date: _____

Signed by (Parent or Teacher): _____

Family Discussion Cards

Card 1: What was your favorite clue from this book?
Card 2: What was the coolest mystery you solved?
Card 3: Why do you think God hid so many clues about Jesus?
Card 4: How does it feel to know Jesus is the greatest treasure?
Card 5: Who is someone you can tell about Jesus?
Card 6: What is your favorite prayer from this book?
Card 7: If you could ask Jesus one question, what would it be?
Card 8: What is one way you can show Jesus' love to someone today?
Card 9: What is your favorite coloring page from this book?
Card 10: What is one thing you want to remember about Jesus forever?

A Note for the Parent: Building on the Foundation

You did it. You spent 30 days being detectives with your children. But the adventure does not end here. It is just beginning.

Here are a few tips to keep going:

1. Make it a habit, not a chore. Do not stress about reading the Bible for 30 minutes a day. A simple 5 minute rhythm before bed is better than an hour once a month.
2. Let them see you reading. Kids do what they see. Let them catch you reading your Bible. Let them see that it matters to you.
3. Ask "Where is Jesus?" in every story. Whenever you read a Bible story, ask your child, "Where do you see Jesus in this story?" This trains them to look for Jesus everywhere.
4. Recommended next steps. Read The Jesus Storybook Bible by Sally Lloyd-Jones. Read The Biggest Story by Kevin DeYoung. Keep pointing them to the Treasure.

You are doing a great job. Keep going.

Sneak Peek: The Great Adventure

If you loved this adventure, there is another one waiting for you. The Great Adventure takes you on a journey through connecting the lives of Old Testament heroes to Jesus. It is full of activities, coloring pages, and simple prayers.

Final Call to Action

Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of families. The adventure is not over. The journey is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept (The Children's Edition)

A bright yellow or sky blue background. A cartoon child detective with a magnifying glass. The child is looking at a big, glowing scroll with fingerprints and footprints on it. A small, friendly cartoon lamb is sitting next to the child. The title THE OLD TESTAMENT DETECTIVE is in a chunky, bouncy, playful font. The word DETECTIVE is in bright red with a magnifying glass replacing the letter D. The overall feel is fun, exciting, and irresistible to a child.